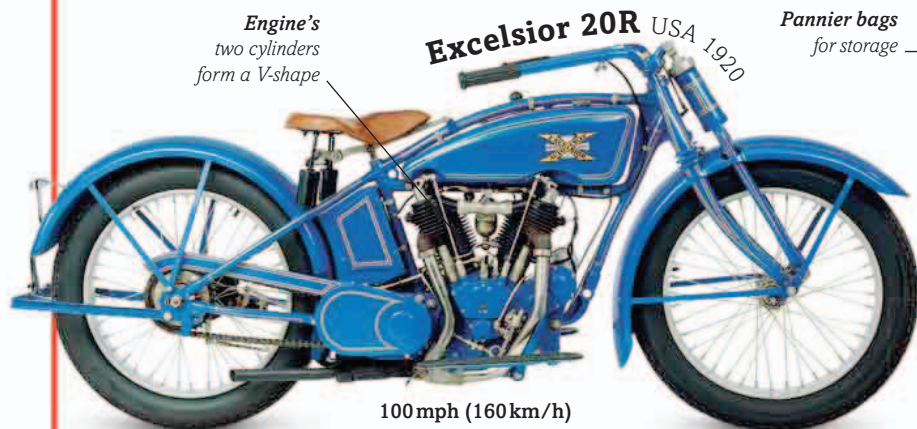


Fastest on two wheels

A 1929 SS100 once sold for a record **£315,100** (about \$460,000) at auction in the UK.



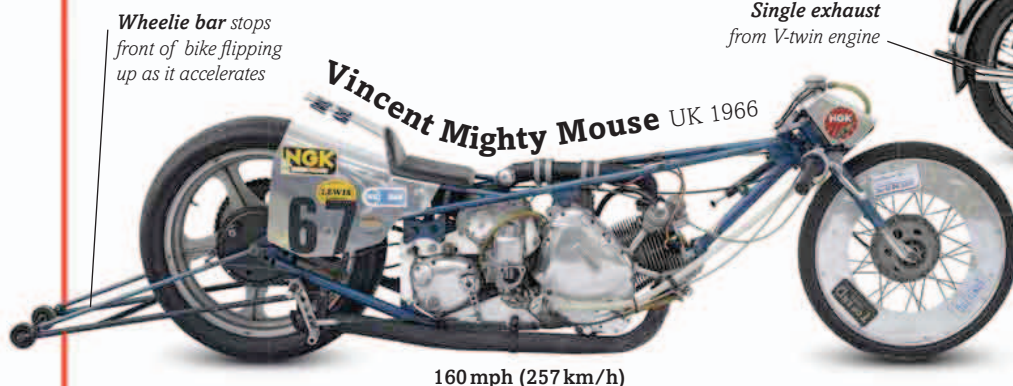
Pannier bags for storage



Brough Superior SS100
UK 1927



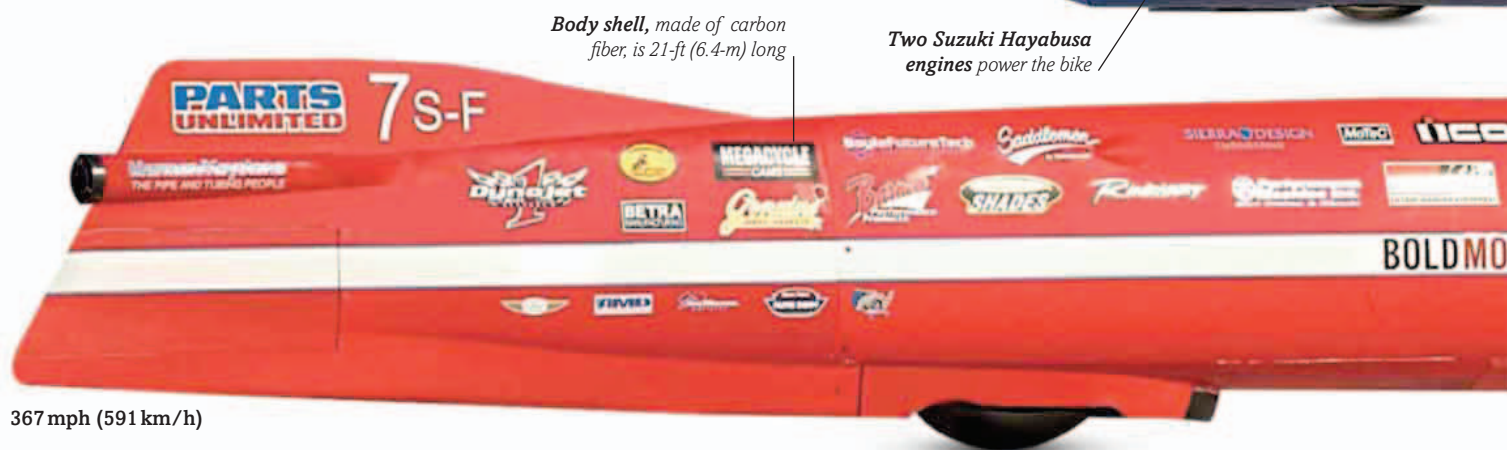
Single exhaust from V-twin engine



Wheelie bar stops front of bike flipping up as it accelerates



Two Suzuki Hayabusa engines power the bike



Body shell, made of carbon fiber, is 21-ft (6.4-m) long

Ever since motorcycles were built, they have been raced or tested to see just how fast they would go. Designers, engineers, and riders would push everything to the limit to squeeze every drop of speed from their magnificent machines.

The **Excelsior 20R** was one of the first motorcycles to reach 100mph (160km/h). It was overtaken by the **Brough Superior SS100** and later the **Vincent Mighty Mouse**, which became the fastest single-cylinder motorcycle when it raced along drag strips in the 1960s. Most modern